Rachel and the listenbrainz outreach decision

> Bottom line: Rachel should use the app to investigate listenbrainz, but should hold it for classification and ownership verification before adding it to the outreach candidate list. The app's rank is a useful screening signal, not proof that the label identifies a contactable client maintainer or an eligible outreach target.

1. The person and the decision

Rachel is a fictional ListenBrainz integration coordinator who maintains a list of submission clients that the MetaBrainz Foundation may investigate and contact. When a client appears at the top of the shortlist, Rachel must decide whether to add it to the outreach candidate list now or hold it for classification verification first. A poor decision could send outreach toward an unverified label or cause Rachel to overlook a real client that needs better recording metadata.

Her case is the client label listenbrainz, which ranks first with score 1.000 but is marked unknown by the app.

2. Rachel's situation and alternatives

ListenBrainz's official JSON documentation (https://listenbrainz.readthedocs.io/en/latest/users/json.html) defines submission_client as the client used to submit a listen and submission_client_version as that client's version. It also defines original_submission_client as the first client when another tool later imports a listen and notes that this field is useful for importers. These fields make the observed label useful for investigation, but they do not establish an owner, maintainer, or outreach eligibility.

The official ListenBrainz Core API documentation (https://listenbrainz.readthedocs.io/en/latest/users/api/core.html) describes submission through submit-listens and distinguishes ordinary submissions from import submissions. Rachel should therefore verify the submission context and metadata before interpreting an aggregate label as a direct-client population.

Rachel's alternatives are to inspect the exact label in the ListenBrainz/MetaBrainz code and issue tracker, search for a repository owner or client documentation, ask the ListenBrainz community, and use current support or maintainer evidence. The MetaBrainz ListenBrainz server repository (https://github.com/metabrainz/listenbrainz-server) directs contributors to its issue tracker and IRC/Matrix/Discord community, giving Rachel public routes for verification and contact.

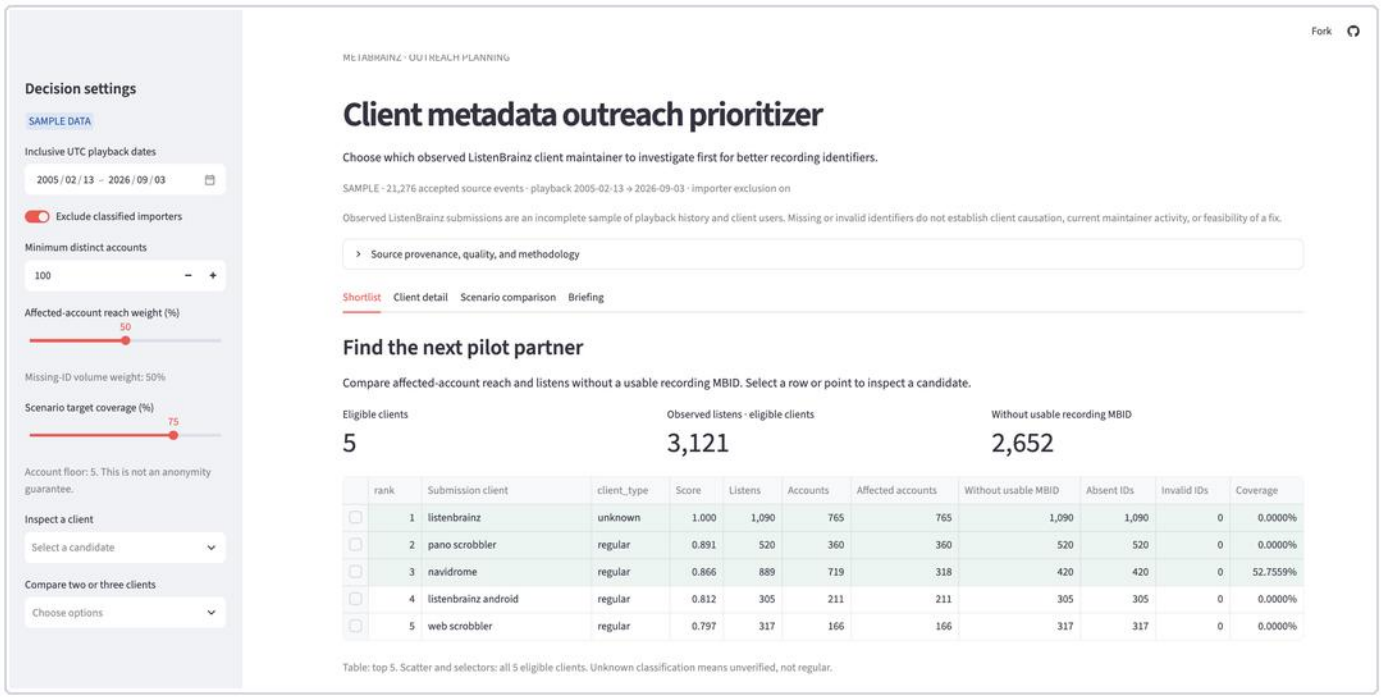
The app does not contain a verified ownership directory, an importer/first-party provenance field, current maintainer activity, support demand, or a causal test showing that the client caused missing recording MBIDs. Those facts matter to Rachel's decision but must come from outside the sample.

3. The app in use

Rachel uses the Client Metadata Outreach Prioritizer (https://appapppy-mdilrzqijilc29whq52tc2.streamlit.app/) in Sample Data mode. The relevant settings are:

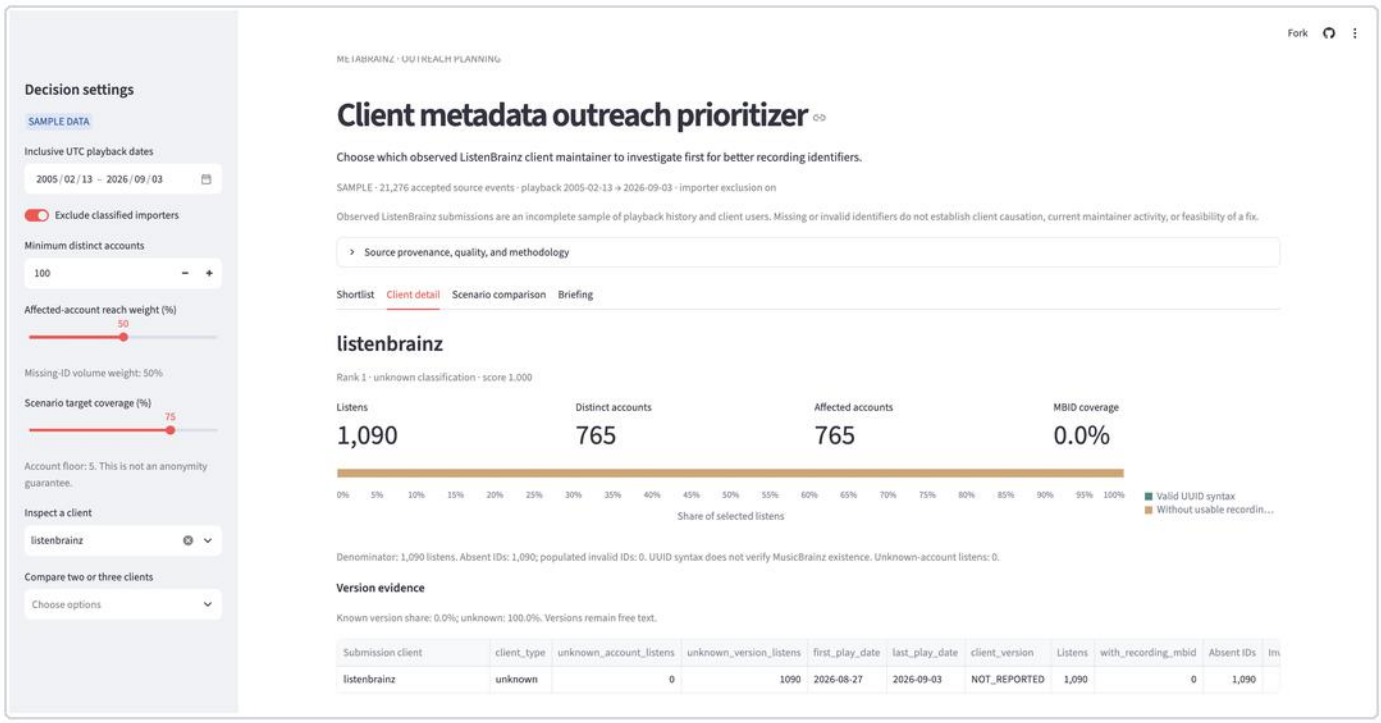
- playback dates: 2005-02-13 through 2026-09-03 UTC;
- classified-importer exclusion: on;
- minimum distinct accounts: 100;
- affected-account reach weight: 50%;
- scenario target: 75%.

She inspects listenbrainz on the Shortlist and then selects it in Client detail.

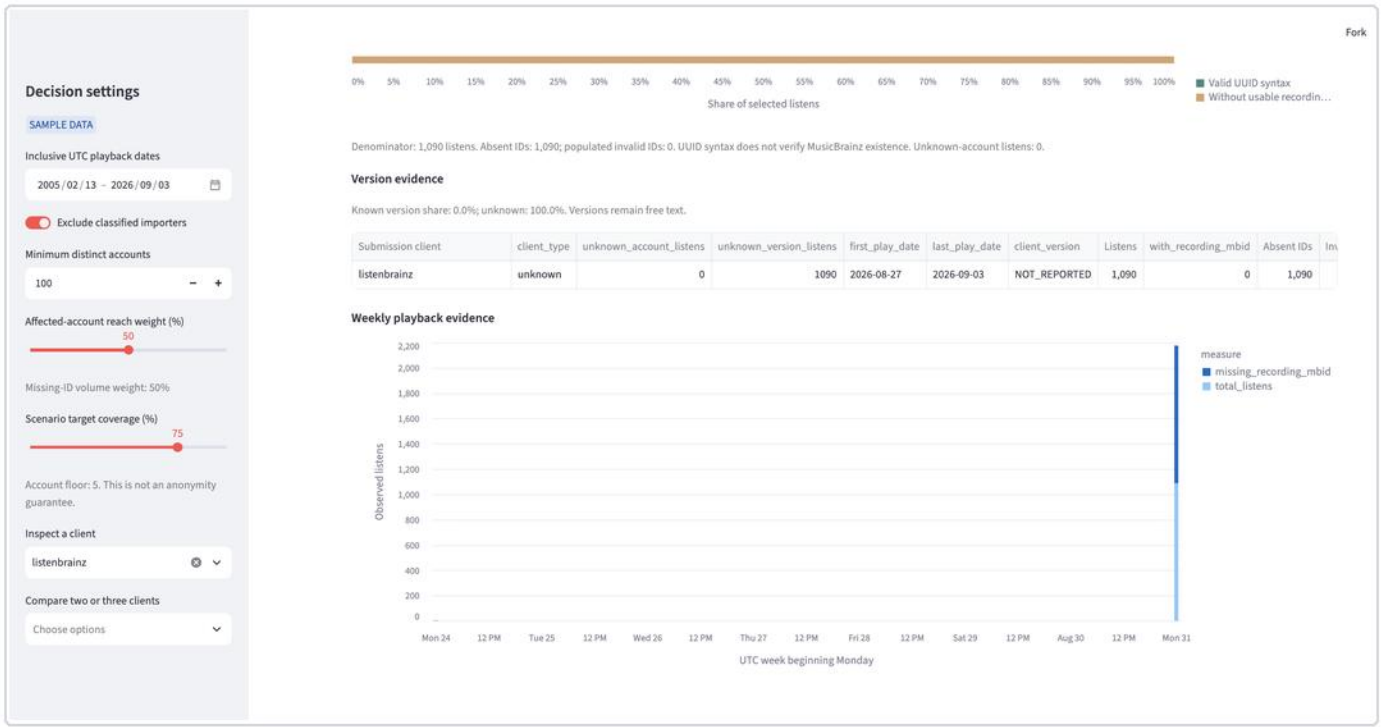


rank	Submission client	client_type	Score	Listens	Accounts	Affected accounts	Without usable MBID	Absent IDs	Invalid IDs	Coverage
1	listenbrainz	unknown	1.000	1,090	765	765	1,090	1,090	0	0.0000%
2	pano scrobbler	regular	0.891	520	360	360	520	520	0	0.0000%
3	navidrome	regular	0.866	889	719	318	420	420	0	52.7559%
4	listenbrainz android	regular	0.812	305	211	211	305	305	0	0.0000%
5	web scrobbler	regular	0.797	317	166	166	317	317	0	0.0000%

Live Shortlist with Rachel's settings and listenbrainz ranked first.



Live Client detail for listenbrainz, including its unknown classification and score.



Live evidence or provenance view showing the sample mode and playback scope.

The live screenshots show 1,090 observed listens, 765 distinct accounts, 765 affected accounts, 1,090 unusable recording MBIDs, 0 valid recording MBIDs, and 0.0% coverage. They also show rank 1, score 1.000, and classification unknown. The evidence view shows that all 1,090 listens have an unreported version and that the selected client's observed playback dates are 2026-08-27 through 2026-09-03 within the broader sample range.

4. Reading the result for Rachel's decision

Does the number measure what Rachel cares about?

Only partly. The score measures the size of the observed listenbrainz aggregate relative to the other rows on two screening inputs: affected accounts and listens without a usable recording MBID. It does not measure whether listenbrainz is a standalone submission client, who maintains it, whether it is an importer, or whether anyone is available to contact.

The code confirms this distinction. rank_clients computes the score from affected_accounts and missing_recording_mbid. Separately, clean_event assigns a client type from exact configured importer and regular-client lists. Ranking and outreach eligibility are therefore not the same decision.

Who is in the rows, and who is not?

Each row represents one accepted ListenBrainz submission event. In the sample, the listenbrainz aggregate represents 1,090 events from 765 observed accounts across the selected playback dates—not 765 installations, maintainers, organizations, or outreach requests. Rows without valid positive account identifiers can contribute listens but not distinct-account counts.

The data leave out people who did not submit to ListenBrainz, support reports, inactive installations, ownership information, and a reliable distinction between a direct client and an importer unless metadata and classification rules provide it.

What outside the data matters?

Rachel needs a verified client identity and contact route, the tool's repository or documentation, evidence about first-party versus import provenance, current maintainer activity, and evidence that better recording-MBID coverage is a meaningful outreach issue. The ListenBrainz documentation shows why original-submission provenance can matter, while the MetaBrainz repository identifies public issue and community channels where Rachel can verify the label.

What could Rachel wrongly conclude?

Rachel could read rank 1 and score 1.000 as proof that listenbrainz is the highest-priority outreach client and immediately add it to the candidate list. That conclusion is too strong. The score establishes only that this exact label has the largest observed aggregate under the chosen filters. unknown does not mean importer, and it does not mean regular client; it means the label is in neither configured list. Rachel should hold the label for classification and ownership verification while retaining the ranking as an investigation signal.

Independent calculation

I independently read dataset_listenbrainz/sample/listens_20260904.csv, trimmed and case-folded client labels, counted event rows, counted distinct positive user_id values, counted affected accounts among rows without a syntactically valid UUID recording MBID, and applied the formula in outreach/filters.py.

```
listenbrainz listens 1090 accounts 765 affected 765 valid 0 missing 1090 type unknown
navidrome listens 889 accounts 719 affected 318 valid 469 missing 420 type regular
pano scrobbler listens 520 accounts 360 affected 360 valid 0 missing 520 type regular
web scrobbler listens 317 accounts 166 affected 166 valid 0 missing 317 type regular
listenbrainz android listens 305 accounts 211 affected 211 valid 0 missing 305 type regular
roon listens 86 accounts 63 affected 63 valid 0 missing 86 type regular
```

After importer exclusion and the 100-account floor, listenbrainz is the maximum on both ranking inputs: 765 affected accounts and 1,090 unusable IDs. At reach weight 0.5, both log-normalized terms equal 1, so its score is 0.5 × 1 + 0.5 × 1 = 1.000.

5. Verdict

Break for immediate outreach eligibility; keep as an investigation aid. The app is useful because it surfaces listenbrainz quickly: its observed volume and affected-account reach are large. It is not sufficient evidence to place the label directly on Rachel's outreach candidate list because the app has no verified classification or maintainer identity. Rachel is better off using the app to prioritize a verification step, then using source repositories, issue trackers, documentation, and community channels to decide whether outreach is appropriate.

Proposed change request

CR-09: Separate screening rank from verified outreach eligibility

- From: Rachel case, 2026-11-08
- Part: Shortlist eligibility and client classification
- Evidence: In Sample Data mode with playback dates 2005-02-13 through 2026-09-03, classified-importer exclusion on, minimum accounts 100, and reach weight 50%, the independent sample calculation gives listenbrainz 1,090 listens, 765 distinct accounts, 765 affected accounts, 1,090 unusable IDs, and score 1.000. The configuration lists exact importer and regular-client names; listenbrainz is in neither list and is therefore classified unknown. The loader excludes only NOT_REPORTED and clients below the account floor before ranking; rank_clients does not require client_type == "regular".
- Change: Keep unknown labels visible as investigation leads, but add a clearly separate outreach-eligibility status or filter that requires verified classification and ownership. Label the current rank as screening priority and do not imply that rank alone makes an unknown client an outreach candidate.
- Priority: medium
- Status: open